

App Development on the Cloud

Made Easy with PaaS!

This article looks into the benefits of using the Platform as a Service paradigm to develop applications on the cloud. It also compares a few top PaaS providers in the market today.



For a typical software engineer or developer, a platform might be a simple utility, which is used to develop some applications. However, in the cloud, this view may not necessarily hold true. The concept of PaaS or Platform as a Service has come a long way from just providing simple middleware to users. It now provides a full-fledged, automated application deployment service that can move your code through the different stages of developing software such as development, quality control, testing, production, etc.

Here's a simple definition of PaaS: PaaS is a cloud computing service model that provides scalable application infrastructure and platforms such as application servers, Web and database services, messaging and integration services, etc, on a pay per use basis, without the overhead of buying and managing the underlying software and hardware.

Why PaaS makes sense for application development

There are many benefits of developing applications on the cloud using PaaS, and a few of them are summarised below.

Time and cost savings: Setting up platform-level software is a complex and time consuming activity. PaaS abstracts a lot of the complexities of managing low level infrastructure and application dependencies so that the software developers simply have to upload their code and start running it without having to worry about procuring and configuring additional servers, software licenses, etc. No upfront payments or contracts are required by a PaaS provider. You simply use the platform and pay for what you use.

Scalability and availability: A PaaS platform also provides on-demand scalability and high availability for your applications. If there is an increased workload on your application, then the